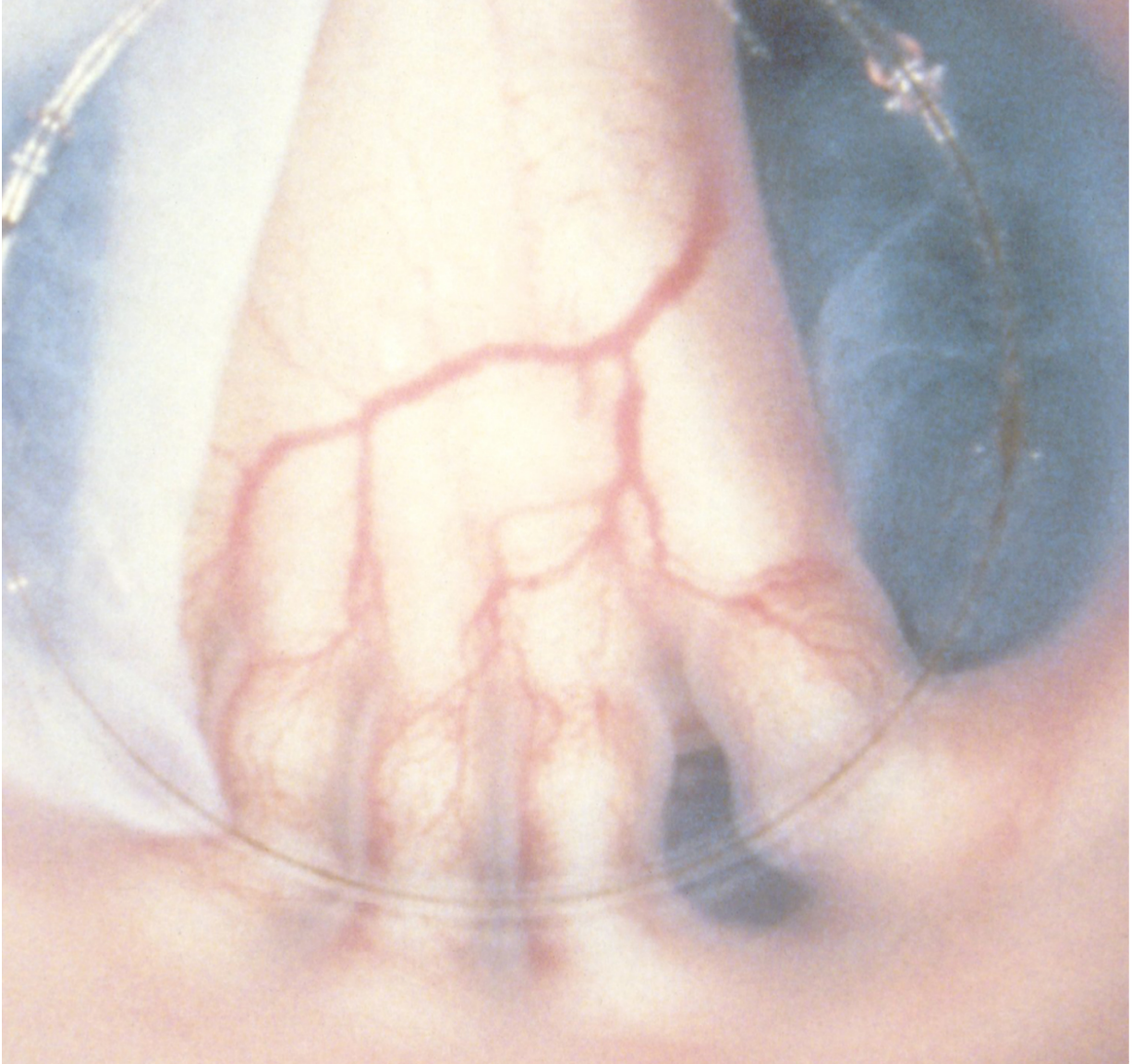




The toes are now fully formed and separated, and their individual bones can be clearly discerned on an ultrasound.

AMNIOCENTESIS

This involves testing the amniotic fluid that surrounds the baby and is normally done at 15–20 weeks (see [Diagnostic tests](#)). It may be offered in the following circumstances:

- When there's a family or pregnancy history of a genetic problem.
- When a screening test (see [Tests for chromosomal abnormalities](#)) has shown that there is a high risk of the baby being born with a chromosomal abnormality.

ASK A DOCTOR

I'm expecting triplets. How will my prenatal care differ? All the usual risks are increased for a multiple pregnancy, partly because hormone levels are higher when there is more than one baby, and because it will be hard work for your body to carry and nourish three fetuses. You will be referred to an obstetrician and have more frequent checkups and scans.